When you view the source of the page, you will see the option you selected has the selected attribute applied to it too (figure 6.9).

```
34
35      <p>You selected Rome with value of 4</p>
36  <form method="post">
37      <div class="mb-3">
38          <label class="form-label" for="SelectedCity">City</label>
39          <select class="form-control" data-val="true" data-val-req
40  <option value="2">Paris</option>
41  <option value="3">New York</option>
42  <option selected="selected" value="4">Rome</option>
43  <option value="5">Dublin</option>
44  </select>
45      </div>
46
```

Figure 6.9 The selected option has the selected attribute applied to it.

You should be able to deduce from this behavior that you can set the selected item in a select tag helper by assigning its value to the property that is bound to its `for` attribute. You didn't assign the value to the `SelectedCity` property yourself, of course; the model binder did it for you.

SETTING THE SELECTED VALUE

In addition to assigning a value to the bound property, you can set the selected value by passing in an additional parameter value to the `SelectList` constructor representing the value of the selected option:

```
var cities = new SelectList(cities, nameof(City.Id), nameof(City.Name), 3);
```

Or you can explicitly construct a collection of `SelectListItem`s and set the `Selected` property on one of the elements to `true`.

Listing 6.11 Constructing a collection of `SelectListItem`s